



HBW OWNER RESOURCE

Spring Launch & First-Run Checklist

A practical Rice Lake launch-day check. The exact Mercury manual still controls.

BOAT

ENGINE / HP

SERIAL NUMBER

Before launch

- ☐ Read the serial-number manual and confirm required maintenance is current.
- ☐ Inspect oil level or oil supply, gearcase for leaks and the propeller for damage or line.
- ☐ Check engine mounting, transom, steering, controls and hydraulic fittings.
- ☐ Inspect fuel hoses, primer bulb where fitted, battery terminals and main connections.
- ☐ Check drain plug, hull, bilge, safety gear, navigation lights and trailer.

First start

- ☐ Ventilate the area and use the cooling-water supply specified by the manual.
- ☐ Never run or dry-crank an outboard without the required water supply.
- ☐ Start in neutral with the lanyard attached. Listen and watch the display.
- ☐ Check for fuel, oil and cooling-water leaks. Confirm normal cooling indication for your model.
- ☐ Let the engine warm normally. Don't race a cold engine on the hose.

First water test

- ☐ Test the lanyard stop switch before leaving the dock.
- ☐ Verify steering, shift, throttle and trim at low speed.
- ☐ Watch gauges and SmartCraft messages. Build load gradually.
- ☐ Confirm cooling behaviour, charging and normal operating temperature for the model.
- ☐ Check the bilge and engine area again after the short test.

Stop the test

- Any overheat, oil-pressure or serious system warning.
- Fuel leak, smoke, fire, strong raw-fuel smell or visible arcing.
- Loss of steering, control, cooling indication or charging.
- New vibration, grinding, severe knocking or propeller damage.
- Water entering the boat faster than the bilge system can manage.

Something isn't right?

Stop before a small launch-day issue becomes an expensive one. Send the serial number, hours and exact symptom to HBW.

[START SERVICE REQUEST](#)

